

Teaching Players What to See

NOVEMBER 11 • ZONE OFFENSE • GAP RECOGNITION • FILM • PROGRAM GROWTH

This Week

1. **They Went Zone Why Are You Changing Your Offense**
2. **Attack Before the Zone Gets Organized**
3. **Arrive Spaced and Attack Gaps**
4. **Teach Decisions Instead of Patterns**
5. **Cause Players to Learn Through Film**
6. **Build the Future Through Elementary Basketball**
7. **Junior High Shootout Recognition**

Coaching Focus

Our offensive principles should not disappear because the defense changes. We still want to create advantages, attack gaps, touch the paint, and make good decisions.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

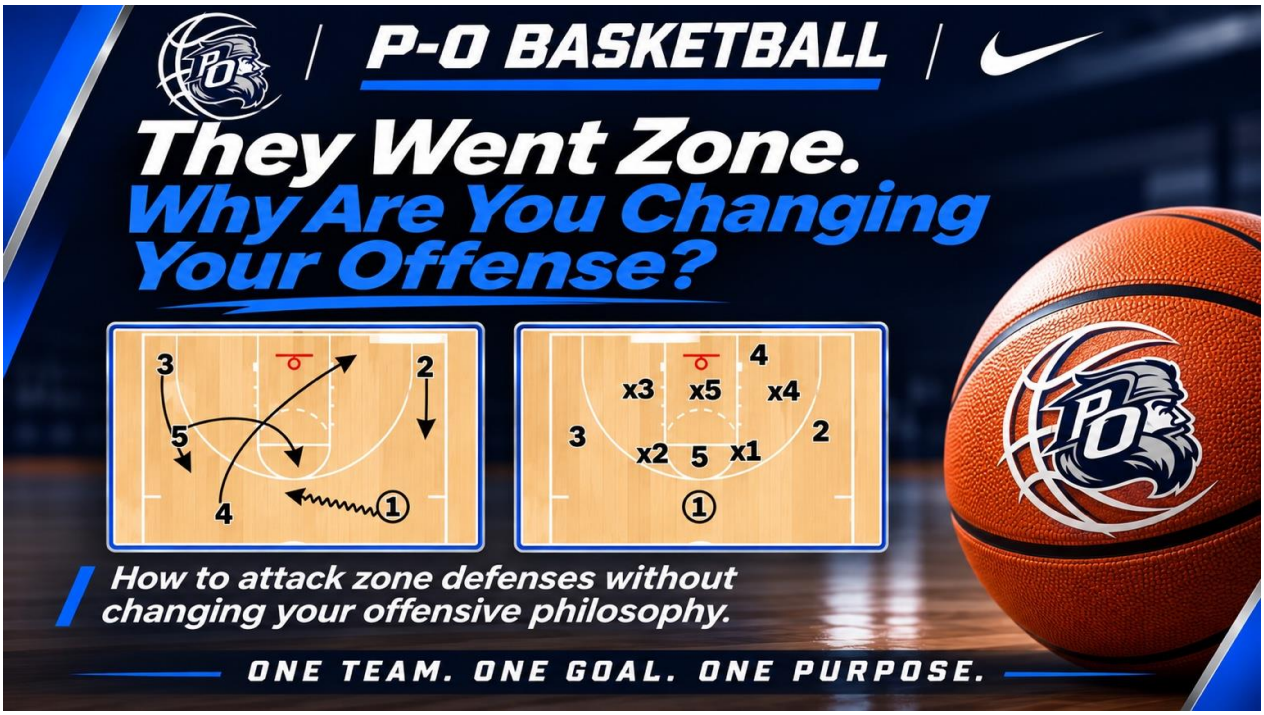
They Went Zone Why Are You Changing Your Offense

One of the things I have changed in how I teach basketball is how I approach attacking zone defenses.

For a long time, the traditional approach was simple: when a team went zone, we called a different offense. We had our man offense, our zone offense, and sometimes multiple sets depending on whether we faced a 2-3, 3-2, or 1-3-1.

> ***Why should our players have to change everything they are doing just because the defense changes?***

Today, I want our players to understand how to attack the defense in front of them, not just memorize another offense.



P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

1 Attack Before the Zone Gets Organized

One of the biggest mistakes teams make against zone defenses is slowing down. They recognize the zone, pull the ball out, and allow five defenders to get organized.

We want to attack before that happens. Our 2-Sided Break allows us to push the basketball, arrive spaced, and find advantages before the defense gets established.

We Want the Same Opportunities

- Rim attacks
- Paint touches
- Open threes
- Defensive rotations that create another advantage

The best opportunity to attack a zone might come before it becomes a zone.



P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

2 Arrive Spaced Do Not Reset

What happens when we do not create an advantage in transition? We flow directly into our spacing.

Whether we use a 5-Out or 4-Out 1-In alignment, our players already understand where they need to be. We do not need to stop the basketball, call another offense, and start over.

Instead, we can use cuts, screening actions, and ball movement to create gaps and force the defense to make decisions.

> ***Spacing is not just about where players stand. It is about creating opportunities for players to make decisions.***

3 Attack Gaps Not the Name of the Defense

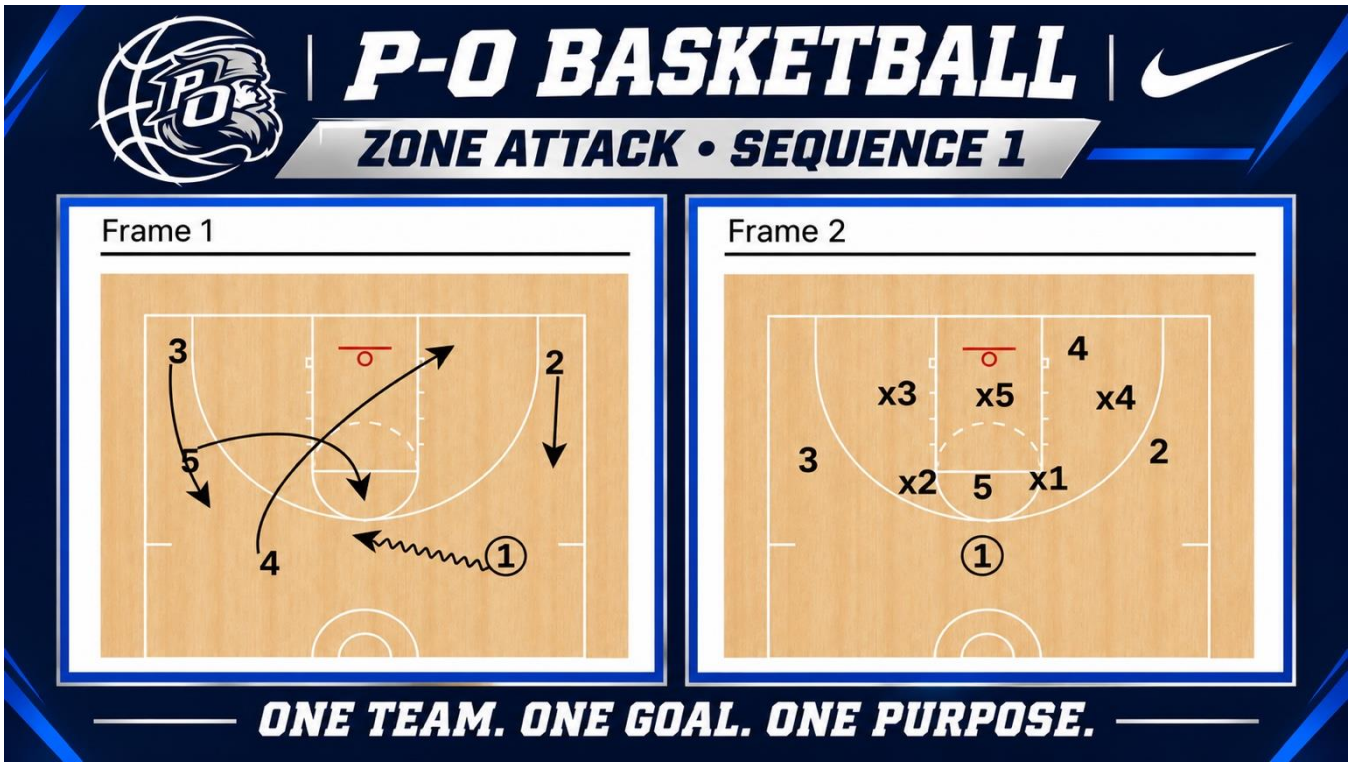
Creating Gaps is one of the pillars of our System Basketball Framework. We teach players to recognize single, double, and triple gaps.

- Move the basketball to shift defenders.
- Use cuts to occupy or remove help defenders.
- Set screens to create advantages.
- Attack seams with penetration.
- Make the extra pass when the defense rotates.

The goal is not simply to move the ball around the perimeter. The goal is to make two defenders responsible for one offensive player and force a decision.

Zone Attack Sequence 1

Arrive in the same spacing, shift the zone, create a gap, and attack before the defense can recover.

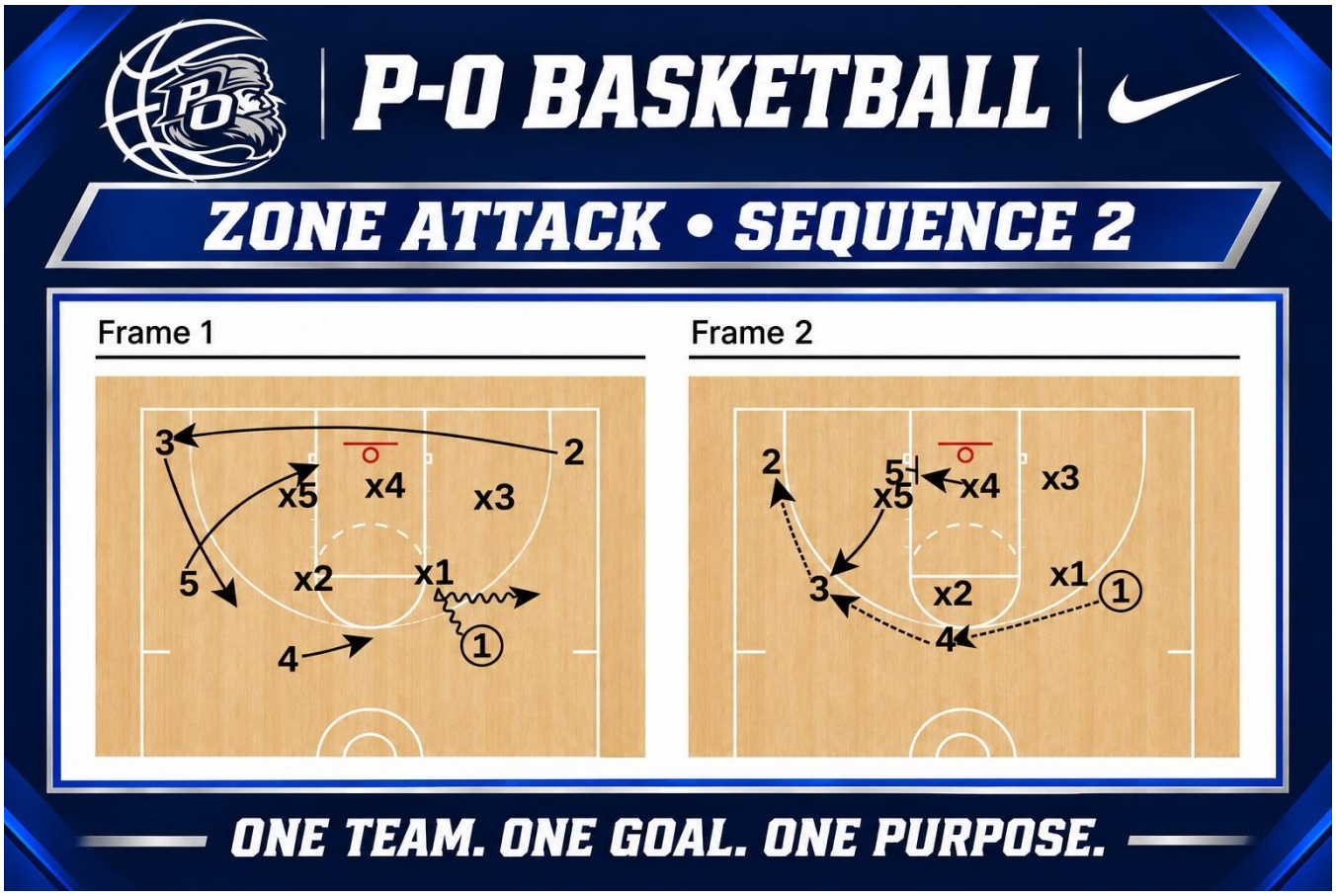


The action organizes the floor. The players still must recognize when the gap opens and make the next decision.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Zone Attack Sequence 2

Use movement to occupy defenders, create two-on-one decisions, and move the ball to the next advantage.



The pattern provides structure, but the read determines whether the offense finishes, drives, or moves the basketball.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

4 Teach Decisions Not Just Patterns

This is the biggest change in my coaching philosophy. I still believe in teaching offensive actions and giving players structure, but I do not want our players dependent on me calling the next play.

I want them to recognize what is happening and react.

Our Offensive Language

Shoot it. Drive it. Move it.

- When you are open, shoot it.
- When you have an advantage, drive it.
- When the defense removes your advantage, move it to a teammate with a better opportunity.

Something to Try at Your Next Practice

Play 4-on-3 against a shifting zone defense. Require the offense to arrive in its spacing and create an advantage through ball movement, penetration, or an offensive action.

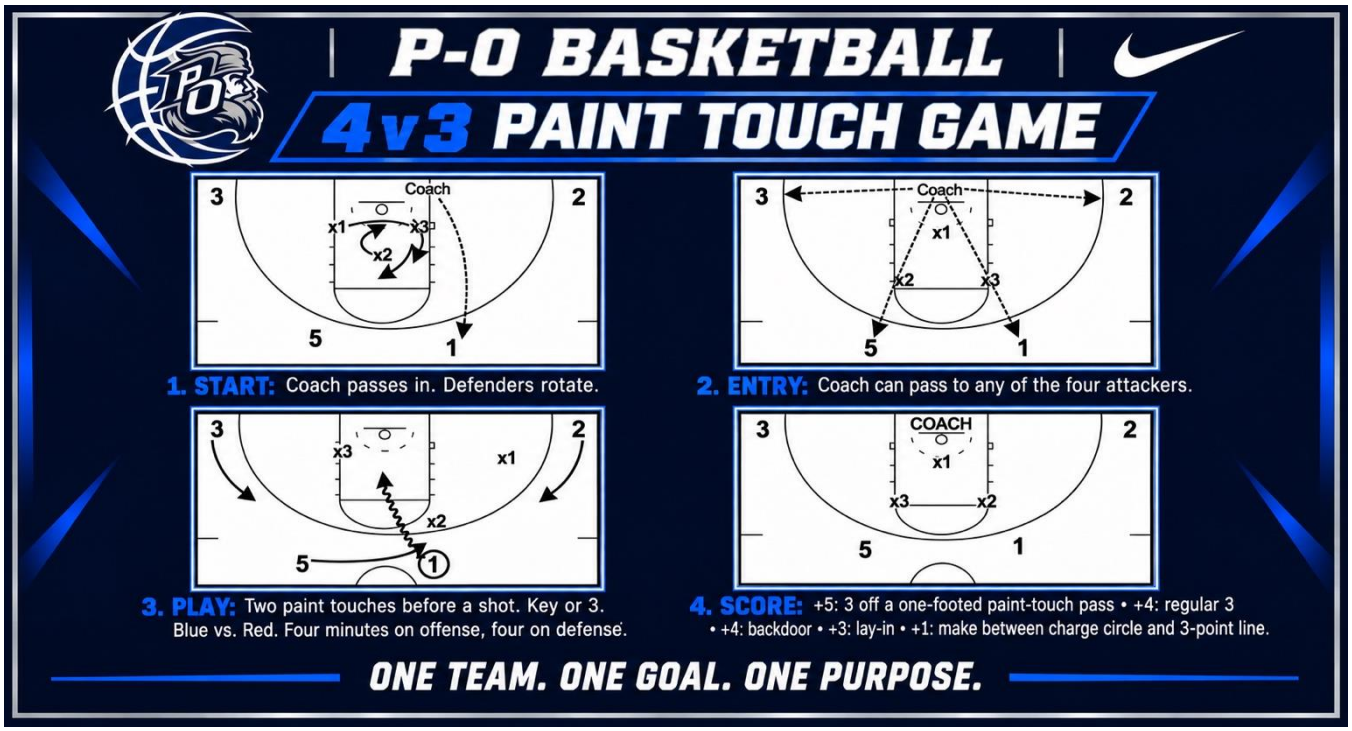
Give the offense a bonus point for a paint touch that creates a quality shot. This encourages players to recognize and create advantages instead of simply passing around the perimeter.

Watch the Teaching

Flowing From Our 2-Sided Break Into Zone Offense

4-on-3 Paint Touch Game

Use this game to connect spacing, paint touches, reads, and decisions against a shifting defense.



Coach the Decisions

- Did the offense arrive in useful spacing?
- Did the ball handler attack a real gap?
- Did the paint touch force a defensive rotation?
- Did the offense make the next pass on time?

Coach's Conversation Week 1

Do Your Players Recognize Gaps Before They Drive

One thing we have emphasized in practice is teaching players to recognize single, double, and triple gaps. We want players to attack advantages rather than force drives into crowded spaces.

Do you explicitly teach gap recognition, or do you allow players to develop that understanding through live play and small-sided games? What drills or teaching methods have worked best for your team?

Film Never Lies

When trying to teach your team, remember that film never lies. Players may remember a possession differently, but film gives everyone the same picture.

Show players what is happening. Then show them the fix. Use short clips, clear questions, and specific language that connects directly to what they will practice next.

- What gap did you see?
- Which defender was responsible for stopping the drive?
- Where was the next advantage?
- What could we do earlier on the next possession?

Cause Them to Learn

As a coach, it is your job to cause your team to learn. If players do not understand something, we have to examine how well we taught it.

Coaches sometimes say, 'They just do not get it,' 'I have told them a thousand times,' or 'These kids are unteachable.' Believing those things gets us nowhere.

> ***The job is not only to explain. The job is to create learning.***

Spend time developing as a teacher. The best teachers do not depend on having the best students. They create an environment where learning is expected, supported, and repeated.

If players are not understanding something, explain it a new way. Demonstrate it. Show film. Reduce the number of decisions. Add the defender back. Ask the player to teach it to a teammate. Learn how each player processes information and meet him there.

Blaming players is easy. Great coaches problem-solve and find a way to cause learning.

Coaching Reminder

Coaching is a gift and a blessing. Be grateful for the opportunity to lead, for the lessons learned along the way, for the chance to belong to a team, and for the impact you can have on a young person.

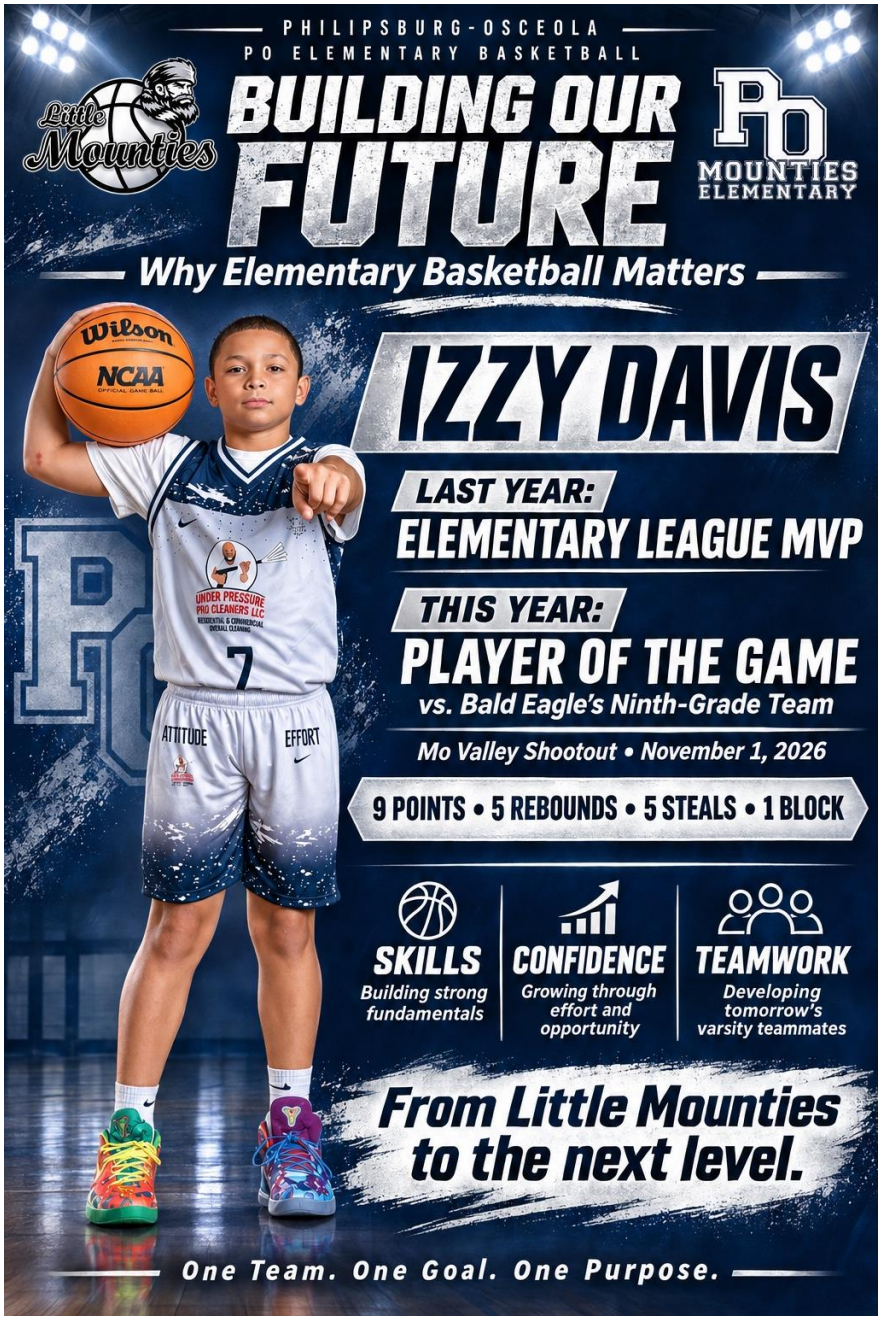
Do not take the opportunity for granted. Before we know it, the season and the role will be gone.

Building Our Future Why Elementary Basketball Matters

Last year, Izzy Davis earned MVP honors in the P-O Elementary Winter Basketball League's 5th and 6th Grade Division. This year, he took another step forward by earning Player of the Game against Bald Eagle's ninth-grade team at the Mo Valley Shootout.

In the Mounties' close 38-34 loss on November 1, Izzy contributed nine points, five rebounds, five steals, and one blocked shot. He made all three of his free throws and committed just one turnover.

Those numbers reflect scoring, defending, rebounding, and taking care of the basketball against older competition. His performance gives younger players a meaningful example: a fellow Little Mountie carrying his development into the next level.



P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

The Foundation Starts Early

Our elementary program gives children opportunities to learn footwork, ball handling, passing, shooting, and defensive positioning. Through practices and games, they also learn how to listen, accept correction, respond to mistakes, and support teammates.

These lessons take time and repetition. A young player who learns to compete through a difficult possession, make the extra pass, or sprint back on defense is building habits that can carry into Junior High and Varsity basketball.

How the Feeder Program Helps

- Future players arrive with a stronger fundamental foundation.
- Shared language and expectations can grow across grade levels.
- Teammates gain experience communicating, trusting, and competing together.
- Our Defend, Rebound, Run identity can begin through age-appropriate lessons.

Development Must Stay at the Center

Parents are right to care about children being left out, friendship groups influencing opportunities, or young players being labeled too early. Those concerns deserve attention.

A feeder program benefits the school program when it welcomes beginners, explains expectations, provides opportunities to improve, and recognizes that children develop at different rates.

Our Elementary League and Select opportunities have different purposes and competitive expectations, but both should support the same goal: helping more children grow, enjoy basketball, and remain connected to the P-O program.

Every Player's Growth Matters

An elementary roster or award should never become a prediction of a child's ceiling. We must keep teaching and encouraging the player who is just starting, the player who needs more time, and the player ready for a greater challenge.

Izzy's progress is worth celebrating, and every player's growth matters. We should also celebrate the child who gains confidence using his weaker hand, makes his first basket, learns to defend without fouling, or becomes a dependable teammate.

Parents, thank you for bringing your children to practices, encouraging them through challenges, and supporting the coaches and volunteers who make these opportunities possible.

> ***The future of P-O Basketball is already learning the game in our elementary gyms.***

2026-27 Elementary Coaches

- Maximilian Kennedy
- Kyleigh Kennedy
- Eric Sherkel
- Craig Stodart
- James Yeckley
- Cara Ricotta
- Phil Delgrotti
- Dillon Hauck
- Chelsea Twigg
- Caleb Cuneo
- Sue Patterson
- Tammy Patterson
- Kelly Bowie
- Timothy Mills

Elementary practices started this week. Good luck to every coach and team. Thank you for all you do for the children in our community. We truly appreciate you.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Junior High Program Update

The P-O Junior High team finished 2-1 in the Mo Valley Fall Shootout as it prepared for the opening of the season.

The Mounties defeated West Branch 36-29 and edged Curwensville 29-27. The team used defensive pressure, timely scoring, and strong individual performances throughout the event.

Congratulations to the players and coaches. The program is heading in the right direction, and the work now turns toward the regular season.



P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Mounties Defeat West Branch 36-29

The P-O Junior High boys basketball team earned a 36-29 victory over West Branch at the Mo Valley Shootout on November 1, 2026, combining defensive pressure with strong free-throw shooting.

P-O led 17-15 at halftime, then outscored West Branch 19-14 in the second half to finish with a seven-point win.

Dylan Novais led the Mounties with 13 points on 4-for-6 shooting, including 2-for-4 from three-point range. He made three of four free throws and added three rebounds, three steals, two deflections, and only one turnover.

Jace added 12 points, two three-pointers, three rebounds, two assists, and three steals. Rylan Wooster collected a team-high nine rebounds and scored eight points, while Izzy Davis supplied four assists, five steals, three rebounds, and no turnovers.

The Mounties recorded 14 steals and nine deflections and made 10 of 12 free throws. West Branch committed 21 turnovers.



OUR TOWN
OUR KIDS
OUR PRIDE

COMMUNITY
SCHOOLS
SPORTS
TRADITION
FAMILY

The Mountie Musket

PHILIPSBURG'S HOMETOWN NEWSPAPER

NOVEMBER 1, 2026 | PHILIPSBURG, PA | SPORTS EDITION | VOL. 1, NO. 5 | $1.00

MOUNTIES TAKE THE WIN

P-O defeats West Branch, 36–29 • Novais earns Player of the Game

By The Mountie Musket Staff

The P-O Junior High boys basketball team earned a 36–29 victory over West Branch at the Mo Valley Shootout on November 1, 2026, combining defensive pressure with strong free-throw shooting.

P-O took a 17–15 lead into halftime, then outscored West Branch 19–14 in the second half to finish with a seven-point win.

Dylan Novais led the Mounties with 13 points, shooting 4-for-6 from the field, including 2-for-4 from three-point range. He converted three of four free throws and added three rebounds, three steals and two deflections with just one turnover.

Jace added 12 points, two three-pointers and two made free throws, plus three rebounds, two assists and three steals.

Ryan Wooster collected a team-high nine rebounds, including three offensive boards. He scored eight points on 2-for-4 shooting and 4-for-4 free throws, adding two steals and two deflections.

Izzy Davis contributed four assists, five steals, three rebounds, two deflections and one point without a turnover.

Santino Reinke added two points, an assist and a deflection. Cam Richards contributed two rebounds and an assist.

The Mounties recorded 14 steals and nine deflections. West Branch finished with 21 turnovers to P-O's 12. P-O made 10 of 12 free throws (83.3 percent), helping offset West Branch's 37–22 rebounding advantage.

PLAYER OF THE GAME
DYLAN NOVAIS

13 POINTS
4-FOR-6 FIELD GOALS
2-FOR-4 THREE-POINTERS
3-FOR-4 FREE THROWS
3 REBOUNDS
3 STEALS
2 DEFLECTIONS
1 TURNOVER

His shooting efficiency and defensive activity helped the Mounties secure the victory.

MOUNTIES

One Team. One Goal. One Purpose.

SMALL TOWN ◆ BIG STANDARDS

P-O Player of the Game Dylan Novais

His shooting efficiency and defensive activity helped the Mounties secure the victory.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Mounties Edge Curwensville 29-27

The P-O Junior High boys basketball team earned a hard-fought 29-27 victory over Curwensville at the Mo Valley Shootout on November 1, 2026.

The Mounties trailed 16-13 at halftime before rallying to secure the two-point win.

Rylan Wooster led P-O with 14 points and seven rebounds, shooting 6-for-12 from the field and making both free throws. He also contributed four steals, an assist, and a deflection.

Dylan Novais added 10 points, including two three-pointers, and a team-high four assists. Jace contributed two points, three rebounds, three assists, and four steals. Izzy Davis added two points, one block, and two deflections.

P-O recorded 12 steals and 10 deflections, helping the Mounties overcome a 30-21 rebounding disadvantage.



OUR TOWN OUR KIDS OUR PRIDE

COMMUNITY SCHOOLS SPORTS TRADITION FAMILY

The Mountie Musket

PHILIPSBURG'S HOMETOWN NEWSPAPER

NOVEMBER 1, 2026 PHILIPSBURG, PA SPORTS EDITION | VOL. 1, NO. 5 | $1.00

MOUNTIES EDGE CURWENSVILLE

P-O wins 29–27 • Wooster earns Player of the Game

By The Mountie Musket Staff

The P-O Junior High boys basketball team earned a hard-fought 29–27 victory over Curwensville at the Mo Valley Shootout on November 1, 2026, led by Rylan Wooster's scoring, rebounding and defensive effort.

The Mounties trailed 16–13 at halftime before rallying to secure the two-point win.

Wooster led P-O with 14 points and seven rebounds, shooting 6-for-12 from the field and making both free throws. He added four steals, an assist and a deflection.

Dylan Novais added 10 points on 4-for-9 shooting, including 2-for-4 from three-point range. He recorded four assists, one rebound, one steal and two deflections.

Jace contributed two points, three rebounds, three assists and four steals, tying Wooster for the team lead in steals.

Izzy Davis finished with two points, one rebound, one steal, one blocked shot and two deflections.

Cam Richards added one point, two rebounds, one steal and three deflections.

Santino Reinke supplied two rebounds, an assist and a steal.

P-O recorded 12 steals and 10 deflections, while Curwensville finished with 24 turnovers. That defensive activity helped the Mounties overcome a 30–21 rebounding disadvantage.

The Mounties finished 12-for-39 from the field, including two three-pointers, and converted three of six free throws.

Stat note: P-O's listed half scores total 27; this recap uses the reported 29–27 final and matching box-score total.

PLAYER OF THE GAME

RYLAN WOOSTER

14 POINTS

7 REBOUNDS

4 STEALS

6-FOR-12 FIELD GOALS

2-FOR-2 FREE THROWS

1 ASSIST

1 DEFLECTION

His efficient scoring, work on the boards and defensive pressure stood out in a game decided by just two points.

MOUNTIES

One Team. One Goal. One Purpose.

SMALL TOWN ◆ BIG STANDARDS

P-O Player of the Game Rylan Wooster

His efficient scoring, work on the boards, and defensive pressure stood out in a game decided by two points.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Countdown to the Season

The 2026-27 season begins in nine days. Every practice is another opportunity to sharpen our habits, improve our decisions, and prepare to compete together.



Keep teaching. Keep learning. Keep building.

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE

Mountie Website Links

Stay connected with every part of the P-O Basketball program.

Varsity Basketball

Youth Basketball

Little Mounties Sports Complex

TJ's Central PA Lions

P-O Select Team League

Final Thought

I do not believe every team needs to run the same offense. I do believe players become better when they understand why something works, not only where they are supposed to run.

> ***Create advantages. Attack gaps. Make good decisions.***

Keep teaching the game.

Coach Tj Anderson
P-O Boys Basketball

P-O BOYS BASKETBALL • ONE TEAM • ONE GOAL • ONE PURPOSE